INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Professional Development

PRINCIPLES OF FINANCE

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain possible career advancement patterns for jobs.
2. Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.
3. Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development.
4. Balance personal and professional responsibilities.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a staff accountant at BRENNAN & COLE, a mid-sized accounting firm. A bookkeeper (judge) at the firm wants your advice on getting promoted.

The bookkeeper (judge) has worked at BRENNAN & COLE for three years and wants to become a staff accountant like you. Here is what the bookkeeper (judge) knows:

- Bookkeepers at the firm earn about $44,000 a year. Staff accountants earn about $62,000.
- Staff accountants need a bachelor's degree in accounting. The bookkeeper (judge) has an associate degree.
- The firm will pay up to $5,250 a year in tuition for employees taking college courses.
- The firm offers free online training and a mentoring program for new employees.

The bookkeeper (judge) is a single parent of two young children and works long hours during tax season, January through April. The bookkeeper (judge) is unsure how to fit school into an already busy life.

The bookkeeper (judge) wants you to explain how careers typically advance in accounting, why continuing education matters, what resources could help and how to balance work, school and family.

You will present the information to the bookkeeper (judge) in a meeting at the office. The bookkeeper (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking for advice. After you have presented the information and answered the bookkeeper's (judge's) questions, the bookkeeper (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your help.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What could I do now, before finishing my degree, to show the partners I'm ready for more responsibility?
2. How do I ask my manager for flexibility without it hurting my chances at a promotion?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain possible career advancement patterns for jobs.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Balance personal and professional responsibilities.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
					TOTAL SCORE	